

Project Atlas Program Brief

Document code	PAB-031
Owner	Transformation Office
Version	1.6
Effective date	5 September 2026

Program overview

Project Atlas modernizes order fulfillment at Northstar Electronics through warehouse automation, improved inventory visibility, and standardized operating procedures. The initial pilot is located at the Bengaluru distribution center.

Priya Nair is the program lead. Daniel Cho owns technology integration, Amina Yusuf owns warehouse readiness, and Marcus Lee is executive sponsor. The pilot must demonstrate safe operation and measurable cycle-time improvement before wider rollout.

The approved target is a 20 percent reduction in average pick-to-pack time while maintaining order accuracy above 99.5 percent.

Contents

- 1. Program overview
- 2. Scope and success measures
- 3. Solution architecture
- 4. Critical dependencies
- 5. Teams and decision rights
- 6. Milestones and current status
- 7. Risks, mitigations, and next decisions

2. Scope and success measures

In scope are conveyor controls, scanning stations, warehouse-system interfaces, operator training, exception handling, and pilot performance measurement. Building expansion and last-mile carrier replacement are out of scope.

Success is measured through throughput, order accuracy, equipment availability, manual interventions, safety observations, and recovery time. A faster line is not considered successful if it creates unmanageable exceptions.

The steering committee approves changes that alter cost, safety, launch date, or the committed pilot scope.

3. Solution architecture

The warehouse management system releases tasks to the Atlas orchestration service. Scanning stations confirm item identity, while conveyor control cabinets direct physical movement and report equipment state.

Kestrel Logistics is the systems integrator for conveyor controls. Each cabinet includes an Orion Control Module manufactured by Helios Components. The module translates orchestration commands into equipment-level signals.

Operational dashboards receive status events but do not control the line. Manual stop controls remain available at every staffed zone.

4. Critical dependencies

The pilot depends on Orion Control Module availability, Kestrel cabinet integration, warehouse network readiness, clean product-location data, trained operators, and completion of the safety assessment.

Helios Components is the sole qualified Orion supplier for the pilot configuration. Nova Circuits is being assessed as an alternate but is not yet approved for production use.

A late control module affects cabinet testing, integrated testing, operator training, and launch readiness in sequence. The program therefore treats component quality as a schedule-critical risk.

5. Teams and decision rights

Priya Nair coordinates the integrated plan and escalates cross-team risks. Daniel Cho accepts technology interfaces. Amina Yusuf accepts warehouse operating readiness. Quality Engineering accepts component containment and requalification evidence.

Kestrel Logistics may recommend technical workarounds but cannot approve use of quarantined Helios components. Only Northstar Quality Engineering can release affected lots.

The go-live decision belongs to the steering committee after receiving recommendations from Safety, Quality, Technology, and Operations.

6. Milestones and current status

Design freeze completed on 18 July 2026. Cabinet build began on 4 August. Integrated testing was originally planned for 14 September, operator training for 28 September, and pilot launch for 12 October.

Quality Incident Q3-17 placed Helios lot HC-447 on hold. Integrated testing moved by twelve calendar days because replacement Orion modules were required. Training was resequenced to protect the revised launch plan.

The current forecast is a 24 October pilot launch, subject to successful replacement-lot validation and a five-day stability test.

7. Risks, mitigations, and next decisions

The leading risk is continued single-source exposure for the Orion Control Module. Mitigations are six weeks of safety stock, accelerated Nova Circuits qualification, and design review for a more interchangeable module interface.

Other risks include incomplete location data, operator adoption, network interruption, and excessive exception volume. Each has an owner, leading indicator, and contingency recorded in the program risk log.

The next steering decision is whether to retain the 24 October launch or reduce initial pilot volume. The decision will use replacement-lot results, training completion, and stability-test evidence.